Debut

Plan it. Launch it. Grow it.

HOW-TO GUIDE FOR FOUNDERS, CONSULTANTS, COACHES AND CREATORS

Debut for Personal Brands

Build authority, an audience and inbound demand, one consistent week at a time.

Inside this guide

- Set up in 30 minutes and your first 7 days
- Plan, create and schedule content that compounds
- Use AI drafts without losing your voice
- Pitch podcasts and events, capture leads, track results
- Weekly rhythm, plans and fill-in templates

Version September 2026. Screens and limits described match Debut at the time of writing; the Pricing page always shows current pl

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1. Welcome: your personal brand, run like a small business

Personal branding works when you show up consistently, say something useful, and make it easy for the right people to contact you. Most people fail at the system, not the ideas: no plan, no calendar, no follow-up, no numbers. Debut is that system in one place.

Step	The question	Where in Debut
1. Position	Who do I help, with what outcome, and why me?	Personas, Brand Kit, GTM Plans, Launch Checklist
2. Plan	What will I say, on which platform, on which day?	Idea Bank, Content Items, Calendar, Mood Boards
3. Create	How do I draft faster without sounding generic?	AI Studio (personal brand tasks), Content Library
4. Grow	How do opportunities and enquiries reach me?	Opportunities, Leads, lead-capture form
5. Measure	Is it working, and what should I do more of?	KPI Log, Analytics, monthly Report

Good to know: Debut plans and tracks, you publish

Debut does **not** post to LinkedIn, Instagram or X for you, and it never reads your social accounts. You draft and schedule inside Debut, copy the text to the platform yourself, then mark the item **Published**. This keeps your accounts safe and your voice yours.

How to use this guide

Read sections 2 and 3 first and do them in order: they take about 30 minutes and one week. Then keep sections 10 (weekly rhythm) and 13 (templates) open as your routine. Menu paths are written like **Account > Two-factor login**: click the first word in the left menu (or the profile link at the bottom), then the second.

2. Set up in 30 minutes

1. **Create your account.** Open Debut and click **Start free**. Enter your name, work email and a workspace name, for example *Priya Sharma | Brand Strategist*. For **Your industry** choose **Personal brand / creator / consultant** and keep **Load my industry starter kit** ticked. Choose a password of 8+ characters and accept the terms.
2. **Verify your email.** Click the link in the email Debut sends. Until you do, a yellow banner shows at the top with a **Resend link** button. Check spam if it does not arrive. **AI Studio only works once your email is verified.**
3. **Turn on two-factor login.** Go to **Account > Set up two-factor**. Scan the QR code with Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, Authy or 1Password, enter the 6-digit code, and **save the 8 recovery codes** somewhere safe (not on the same phone). Your brand is an asset: protect it.

4. **Install Debut on your phone.** Android (Chrome): menu > **Install app**. iPhone (Safari): Share > **Add to Home Screen**. You get an app icon and a slide-in menu for quick notes and approvals.
5. **Look around the dashboard.** You will see a **Personal brand playbook** card with the seven KPIs to watch, a short guided tour pointing out the essentials (Skip or Next through it; replay any time from Help & guides), and a **Get started** checklist. Tick items off as you go through this guide.

What the starter kit already gave you

Because you chose the personal brand mode, Debut pre-loaded a kit so you never start from a blank page:

What	How many	Where to find it
Personal-brand launch checklist items (on top of the standard 8-phase checklist)	16	Strategy > Launch Checklist
Persona templates: Ideal client, Hiring manager / recruiter, Peer community member	3	Strategy > Personas / ICP
Content ideas by pillar, with a one-click + Add to your list	10	Content > Idea Bank
Campaign ideas: 30-day authority sprint, Newsletter launch, Podcast and speaker outreach push	3	Idea Bank, then + Create campaign
KPI scorecard (what to measure and how)	7	Idea Bank, then + Log
Key dates, e.g. National Startup Day, World Book Day, year-end reflection window	6	Content > Key Dates and Calendar
News sources: personal branding, creator economy, speaking and podcasts	3	Intelligence > Latest Updates

Your free trial

Every new workspace gets **14 days with every feature unlocked**, then continues on the **Free plan forever**. Nothing is deleted when the trial ends. Use the trial to try the KPI Log, influencer tools, analytics and Market Pulse, then decide what you need (see section 11).

3. Your first 7 days

This plan follows the personal-brand checklist that Debut loaded for you. Keep each day to 30-45 minutes.

Day	Do this	In Debut
1	**Audit.** Google yourself. Open your LinkedIn, X, Instagram and YouTube. Is the story consistent and current? List 10 people or companies you want to be known by, and where they spend attention.	Launch Checklist > Research items. Add findings to **Reference Links**.
2	**Positioning.** Write one sentence: who you help, the outcome, why you (template in section 12). Turn it into a plan.	Strategy > **GTM Plans** > + New. Put the sentence in *Positioning & value proposition*.

Day	Do this	In Debut
3	**Pillars and voice.** Choose 3 content pillars (one personal, two expertise). Note your voice, tagline and colours.	**Brand Kit**: one entry per item, Kind = Voice & tone, Tagline, Colour, Font.
4	**Profile rewrite.** Generate 3 headline options and an About section, then edit in your own words.	**AI Studio** > *Personal brand: profile rewrite* (1 credit).
5	**Home base.** Put a way to reach you in your bio and Featured section: the Debut enquiry form link, plus a newsletter or booking link.	**Integrations** > hosted enquiry form. Add the link to LinkedIn Featured and your email signature.
6	**Content bank.** Add 10 ideas from the Idea Bank, then schedule 5 of them across the next two weeks.	**Idea Bank** > + Add, then **Calendar**.
7	**Review and commit.** Look at the calendar. Is the cadence one you can keep for 90 days? Reduce it if not. Set your Monday planning slot.	**Calendar** and **Tasks**. Add a recurring reminder in your own calendar app.

Rule of thumb

A modest schedule you keep for a year beats a heroic one you abandon in three weeks. Start with 3 posts a week on one main platform and 10 thoughtful comments a day.

4. Position: personas, brand kit and plan

Personas / ICP: who you are writing for

Open **Strategy > Personas / ICP**. Your kit created three: an **Ideal client (decision-maker)**, a **Hiring manager / recruiter** and a **Peer community member**. Edit each so it sounds like your real audience. The useful fields are **Pain points**, **Goals / jobs to be done**, **Objections**, **Where they spend time** and **Buying triggers**. Every post idea should help one persona with one pain point.

Brand Kit: your voice in writing

Add one entry each for your **Voice & tone** (for example: plain, warm, specific, no jargon), **Tagline**, **Colour** (hex), **Font** and a couple of **Guidelines** (such as *never claim results I cannot show*). AI Studio reads this so drafts sound more like you.

GTM Plans: your 90-day brand plan

Create a plan called *Personal brand: next 90 days*. Fill in **Product / offering** (what you sell: consulting, coaching, speaking, a product), **Primary goal and success metric** (for example: 4 qualified enquiries a month), **Target market**, **Positioning**, **Channel mix** and **Risks**. Move **Stage** from Planning to Launch to Scale as you progress.

Launch Checklist

Strategy > Launch Checklist lists every task by phase: Research, Positioning, Product & Pricing, Channels, Content, Sales & Enablement, Launch and Post-launch. Click **Board view** to drag items through *To do*, *In progress* and *Done*. The dashboard shows overall progress.

5. Plan and create your content

Idea Bank: never stare at a blank page

Content > Idea Bank shows ten ideas grouped by pillar: Story, Framework, Teardown, Opinion, Proof, Behind the scenes, Curation, Q&A, Personal and Lead magnet. Each has a suggested platform and format. Click **+ Add** and it opens a pre-filled content item; adjust the wording to your topic, set a date and save.

Content Items: one row per piece

Each item has a title or hook, **Channel** (LinkedIn, Instagram, X / Twitter, YouTube, Email, Blog / SEO and more), **Format** (Post, Carousel, Reel / Short, Video, Story, Article, Newsletter, Thread and more), **Status**, publish date, target persona, the full **Copy / script**, **Call to action**, hashtags and a link to your design file.

Status flow: Idea, Planned, In progress, Review, Approved, Scheduled, Published (or On hold). Working alone, you will mostly use Idea, In progress, Scheduled and Published. Use Review and Approved when an assistant helps you (section 9).

Calendar: see your whole month

Content > Calendar shows every item on its publish date, plus key dates, promotions and events. **Drag a chip** to another day to reschedule. Use the channel filter to see one platform. Click the **+** on any day to add an item. Ideas without a date wait in the **Unscheduled** list.

Subscribe from your phone: the page shows a private calendar link. Add it in Google Calendar, Apple Calendar or Outlook (subscribe by URL) and your posting plan appears next to your meetings. Keep the link secret; press **Reset link** if it ever leaks.

Mood Boards, Reference Links, SEO Keywords, Content Library

- **Mood Boards** (Content menu): collect visual direction on a freeform canvas, Miro-style. Add an **image upload** (PNG, JPG, GIF or WebP, up to 10 MB), an **image link**, a **colour** (hex), a **note** or a **link**, then **drag any card anywhere and resize it by its corner** — positions save as you go. A **Tidy up** button snaps everything back into a clean grid if it gets messy. Free plan: 3 boards. Starter: 20. Team and above: unlimited.
- **Reference Links:** save articles, examples and inspiration with tags. In **Latest Updates**, save any headline to your references in one click.
- **SEO Keywords:** keep the search terms your ideal client uses, for blog and newsletter topics.
- **Content Library:** stores AI drafts and finished assets you want to reuse.

6. Draft faster with AI Studio (and keep your voice)

Intelligence > AI Studio writes first drafts. It is a helper, not a ghostwriter: always edit, and never publish claims or numbers you cannot back up.

1. Pick a task under **What do you need?** Tasks made for you appear first under *For Personal brand / creator / consultant*.
2. Fill **Product / brand** (who you are and what you offer), **Target audience**, **Tone** and **Extra instructions** (constraints, must-include points, examples of your style).
3. Keep **Use my latest GTM Plan, Brand Kit and Personas as context** ticked. This is why the setup in section 4 matters.
4. Click **Generate** (up to a minute). Then **Copy**, or **Save to Content Library**. For the calendar task, **Import into Calendar** creates dated content items for you.

Task	What you get	Credits
Personal brand: profile rewrite	3 LinkedIn headlines, an About section, featured-section ideas, a positioning line	1
Personal brand: 30-day content plan	Day-by-day plan around 3 pillars, with hooks and a weekly engagement routine	1
Personal brand: speaker bio and one-sheet	50, 100 and 200-word bios, 5 talk titles with abstracts, one-sheet outline	1
Personal brand: podcast / speaker pitch	A short tailored pitch email, subject lines, a follow-up	1
Content calendar (imports to Calendar)	A dated calendar you can import in one click	3
Social posts, Video / Reel script, Email sequence, Landing page copy	Drafts for the piece you name	1 each
Positioning and messaging, Buyer personas, KPI framework, FAQ and objections	Strategy drafts you can refine	1 each
Live research: market scan, competitor intelligence, trends	Web-researched briefs that list their sources	4 each
Full GTM plan, Weekly marketing report, SEO blog brief	Longer documents	2 each

Credits: how far they go

Free plan: **5 credits a month**. Starter: **40**. Team: **250**. Credits reset each month; unused credits do not roll over. On Free, spend your five on the profile rewrite, the 30-day plan, the bio, one pitch and one post series, then write the rest yourself using those drafts as models.

Make drafts sound like you

Paste two or three of your best past posts into **Extra instructions** and write *match this style*. Ask for *specific examples from my field: [your field]*. Then rewrite the opening line yourself. Delete anything that sounds like everyone else.

7. Stay current: Market Pulse and live research

Good personal brands talk about what is happening now. Intelligence > Market Pulse gives you live signals for your field every week, so you never run out of timely things to say.

1. Open **Market Pulse** and press **Refresh now**. Debut pulls live headlines from India and around the world for the topics on your **watchlist** (your kit added three to start), plus what people are searching for today and, when enabled, popular YouTube videos.
2. Read **Rising in headlines**: words and phrases that keep appearing across sources. A green *new* tag means it was not there at the last refresh.
3. Click **Idea** beside any headline to create a content item pre-filled with it (write your own take), or **Save** to keep the article in Reference Links.
4. Click **AI brief** (2 credits) for a plain-language summary: what is happening, what it means for you, five opportunities, three risks, five content ideas and three actions. It cites the numbered headlines it used.
5. Add your own topics under **Watchlist**: keywords, competitors or brands. Free tracks 3, Starter 10, Team 25. Anything you add under **Competitors** is tracked automatically.

Live research in AI Studio

In **AI Studio**, the tasks under *Live web research (with sources)* search the web while they write and list every source they used: **market and category scan**, **competitor intelligence** and **trends and content opportunities**. Any other task can use research too if you tick *Use live web research*. Research costs **2 extra credits** (the three research tasks cost 4 in total), so on the Free plan's 5 credits use it for one or two important questions a month.

What Market Pulse is and is not

It reads public news and trend sources and shows you headlines with links to the original publishers. It does **not** read your LinkedIn or Instagram analytics, and trend words are signals rather than forecasts. Always check a claim at its source before you repeat it.

Public holidays: at the bottom of Market Pulse, choose your country and press **Add holidays** to put the year's public holidays into Key Dates and your Calendar.

8. Grow: opportunities, leads and inbound

Opportunities: podcasts, talks, articles, collaborations

Campaigns > Opportunities is your pitching pipeline. Add each podcast, conference, guest article, media feature, collaboration, award or community you want. Fields: **Type**, **Organiser / host**, contact, **Status** (Idea, Researching, Pitched, In discussion, Confirmed, Done, Declined), event date, **Follow up on**, audience size, link, your **Angle / pitch** and the **Outcome and learnings**. Use **Board view** to drag opportunities between statuses.

Habit: pitch five new opportunities a month, set a follow-up date on every pitch, and use the AI task *Personal brand: podcast / speaker pitch* for the first draft.

Leads: turn attention into conversations

Growth > Leads tracks people who reach out. Stages: **New, MQL, SQL, Opportunity, Won, Lost**, with company, email, phone, deal value and **Next step**. Move each lead along the board and always write a next step.

Capture leads automatically

Go to **Integrations** (left menu, bottom). You will find:

- **Hosted enquiry form:** a public page with your workspace name. Share the link in your LinkedIn Featured section, bio, email signature or as a QR code. Visitors tick a consent box and you get a new lead with the source recorded.
- **Website webhook:** if you have your own website form, point it at the webhook URL (or connect Zapier or Make). Enquiries land in Leads as *New*. Press **Reset webhook URL** if it is ever shared by mistake.
- Only collect details people agree to share, and reply promptly: the first response often decides the sale.

Collaborations and media

PR & Media (Campaigns menu) is available on every plan: keep a list of journalists, editors and podcast producers with notes and follow-ups. **Influencers**, **Discover Influencers** and **Outreach Templates** are part of the Starter plan and above, and help you find and contact collaborators. Discovery builds ready-made search links across Instagram, YouTube, LinkedIn, X and other platforms; Debut does not scrape or invent contacts. Always follow platform rules and disclosure guidelines (for example ASCI rules in India) for paid collaborations.

9. Measure: KPI Log, analytics and your monthly report

The KPI Log and Analytics are part of the Starter plan and above (and unlocked during your 14-day trial). On the Free plan, keep these numbers in a notebook and add them to Debut when you upgrade.

KPI (from your kit)	How to measure	Channel
Follower growth	Net new followers per month	LinkedIn
Engagement rate	Interactions divided by impressions	LinkedIn
Profile views	Weekly profile views	LinkedIn
Inbound leads / DMs	Qualified conversations started by others	All
Speaking / podcast invites	Invitations received per quarter	All
Newsletter subscribers	Total and net new	Email
Posts published	Posts published versus your plan (consistency)	LinkedIn

How to log: open **Growth > KPI Log** (or click **+ Log** next to a metric in the Idea Bank). Enter Metric, Channel, Date, **Actual** and **Target**. Do it once a week, on Fridays. **Analytics** then draws trend charts against your targets, plus campaign budget and lead funnel charts. You can also bring numbers in by CSV (**Import from CSV** on any list) or, on Team and Agency plans, by the API.

Monthly report (print to PDF)

Click **Client report** in the left menu. It summarises the month: KPIs against target with progress bars, campaigns, content published or scheduled, new leads, promotions and events. Use the **Print / save PDF** button, or the arrows to change month. On Starter and above you also get a **read-only share link** (no login) that you can send to a mentor, coach or manager. Reset it any time under **Calendar > Reset link**.

10. Your weekly rhythm

When	Time	What to do in Debut
Monday planning	20 min	Refresh **Market Pulse** and note two timely topics. Open the Calendar. Confirm this week's posts. Add or reorder from the Idea Bank. Check Tasks and Opportunities follow-ups due this week. Read Notifications.
Every day	30 min	Publish today's item from Content Items (copy, post, mark Published). Leave 10 thoughtful comments on target accounts. Answer new leads in Leads the same day.
Friday review	15 min	Log your KPIs. Note the two best posts and why. Move Opportunities forward and set follow-ups. Add three new ideas.

When	Time	What to do in Debut
Monthly	45 min	Open the Client report. Compare to target. Refresh proof (results, testimonials). Pitch five new opportunities. Send your newsletter. Adjust the 90-day plan.

Working with an assistant or ghostwriter

Free and Starter include **one seat** (you). The **Team plan (5 seats)** lets you invite an assistant, editor or designer under **Team & roles > Invite someone**. Choose **Creator** for a writer or designer (they can draft and send to Review but cannot approve or publish), **Manager** for a trusted assistant, or **Lead** if they should run the workflow. Use **comments** on any item with **@Name** to notify them, and the **Owner** field on content items so they know who is responsible. Each person can turn on a **daily digest** email of what needs them.

11. Plans: what you get

Start on the free trial, keep the Free plan, and upgrade only when a limit gets in your way. The Pricing page always shows current prices; upgrades happen under Plan in the left menu.

	Free	Starter	Team	Agency
Team seats	1	1	5	15
AI credits per month	5	40	250	1,000
Records (content items, leads and so on)	100	1,500	10,000	50,000
Mood boards	3	20	Unlimited	Unlimited
Calendar, Idea Bank, Personas, Brand Kit, GTM Plans, Opportunities, Leads, lead form	✓	✓	✓	✓
Market Pulse: topics you can track	3	10	25	50
KPI Log and Analytics, Influencers and Outreach, CSV import	—	✓	✓	✓
Shareable read-only report link	—	✓	✓	✓
Team hub, Lead role, approvals (group mode), REST API	—	—	✓	✓

What happens if I stop paying or the trial ends?

You drop to the Free plan. **Nothing is deleted.** Locked modules (for example KPI Log) hide until you upgrade again, and you can still **edit, delete and export** what you have even above the Free limits. New records stop once you hit the limit.

12. Account, privacy and safety

- **Your theme:** personal-brand workspaces always use the Debut lavender theme, matching the guides and the wider community; it isn't changeable here (business workspaces can pick their own brand colour instead).
- **Two-factor login:** Account > Two-factor. Use recovery codes if you lose your phone; each works once.
- **Daily digest:** Account > Daily digest. One email a day, only when something needs you. Each digest has an unsubscribe link.
- **Notifications:** the bell shows when you are assigned work, @mentioned or asked to approve something.
- **Export your data: Export data** in the left menu downloads a ZIP of spreadsheets (CSV files) of everything. Mood-board images are listed by link; keep your original image files.
- **Your theme:** personal-brand workspaces always use the Debut lavender theme, so your dashboard looks consistent with the guides and the wider community. This isn't changeable for this industry (business workspaces can pick their own brand colour instead).
- **Support access:** authorised Debut staff can open a strictly read-only view of a workspace to help with a support request. Each such visit is recorded in your workspace's activity log.
- **Your content is yours.** Debut stores what you enter to run the service; see the Privacy Policy in the page footer.

13. Templates and a 30-day starter plan

Positioning statement

Fill in the blanks

I help **[who exactly]** to **[achieve this outcome]** by **[your method or angle]**, so they can **[the result they care about]**. Unlike **[common alternative]**, I **[what makes you different, ideally with proof]**.

Content pillars worksheet

Pillar	What I say about it	Proof I can show	Best formats
1. Personal (why I do this)			Story, Q&A
2. Expertise A			Framework, Teardown
3. Expertise B			Opinion, Proof

Friday review (6 questions)

- [ ] Did I publish what I planned? If not, why?
- [ ] Which two posts got the most meaningful responses (not just likes)?
- [ ] How many real conversations started this week?
- [ ] Which opportunities need a follow-up on Monday?
- [ ] What did I learn about my audience?
- [ ] What is one thing to do more of, and one to stop?

Podcast / speaker pitch skeleton

Keep it under 120 words

Subject: A talk idea for [event / show]: [specific angle]

Hi [name], I have followed [something specific from their work]. Your audience of [who] often struggles with [problem]. I can share [3 concrete takeaways] drawn from [your proof: result, client type, experience]. Examples of my work: [link]. Happy to send a full outline. Would [event / show] be a fit in [month]?
[Your name, one line credential]

30-day plan at a glance

Week	Focus	Outputs
1	Position and set up	Audit done, positioning sentence, 3 pillars, profile rewritten, enquiry form linked in bio, 2FA on
2	Build the content bank	10 ideas added, 6 posts scheduled, first mood board, personas edited to sound real
3	Visibility sprint	3 posts a week live, 10 comments a day, 5 opportunities added and 3 pitched
4	Measure and refine	KPIs logged for the month, Client report reviewed, top 2 posts repeated in new formats, month-2 plan written

14. Questions and fixes

Problem	What to do
I cannot see the KPI Log or Influencers.	They are part of Starter and above (unlocked during the 14-day trial). A padlock in the menu marks locked areas.
It says I reached my record limit.	Free allows 100 records. Delete old items, export what you want to keep, or upgrade. You can always edit and delete.
AI says I have used my credits.	Credits reset monthly. Upgrade for more, or use the drafts you already saved in the Content Library.
AI says to verify my email.	Open the verification email and click the link (or press Resend link in the yellow banner). AI Studio works once your email is verified.

Problem	What to do
Where does Market Pulse get its information?	From public news and trend sources and, when enabled, YouTube. It shows headlines and links only. It does not read your social accounts.
Market Pulse shows a note that a source could not be reached.	That source was unavailable at that moment. Everything else is live; refresh again later.
Does Debut post to LinkedIn for me?	No. Copy the text from the content item, post it yourself, then mark the item Published.
Is my data used to train anything?	Debut sends your prompt and selected plan context to its AI provider only to generate your draft. See the Privacy Policy for details.
I lost my phone and cannot log in.	Use one of your 8 recovery codes on the code screen. If you have none, contact support so an administrator can reset two-factor for you.
My calendar link stopped working.	It was reset. Copy the new link from the Calendar page and subscribe again.
The Install app option does not appear.	Use Chrome on Android or Safari on iPhone, and open the site over https. If you already installed it, look for the app icon.
Someone I invited cannot join.	Invites last 7 days and must be opened with the same email address. Check the seat count on your plan (Team and Agency have more seats).

Need help?

Open **Help & guides** in the menu, or use **Send feedback**: it reaches us together with the page you were on. You can also use **Contact** in the page footer.